



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

Happy Birthday to Donald

It was 2015 when we first started to recognise the birthdate of Donald Healey. Born on 3 July 1898 it seemed that gathering together, around that date, likeminded enthusiasts was the most normal thing to do.

The invitation went out to clubs covering those marques that DMH was associated with throughout

his career to join with us for the gathering and a BBQ lunch. It's pleasing to say that the day attracted a wide selection of cars.

Due to the Pandemic the Donald Healey Birthday Display Day has not been held since 2019, but let's hope we can enjoy the day again in the not too distant future.



2015



2018



2019

VOL. 8 ISSUE #10
October 2021

COMING EVENTS

October

7th General Meeting
13th Committee Meeting

November

4th General Meeting
10th Committee Meeting

Watch this Space!

Please note that all meetings will be via Zoom until further notice.

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POST: AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 6494
North Ryde NSW 2113

EMAIL: enquiries@austinhealeynsw.com.au
WEB: www.austinhealeynsw.com.au
FB: www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/

Normally our monthly meetings will be held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the restaurant from 5.30pm.



PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Will they let us travel? If they do, can we, or can't we? If we can, will we, or won't we go to Mildura? What if we get to Mildura and then the border closes? Will we have enough warning to scamper back into NSW to avoid being marooned? These are questions that have been in my mind since organising the Mildura Meander.

As little as a month ago various premiers and health officials from a number of states were pessimistic about the chances of eradicating the Delta strain of Coronavirus. 'Our' Gladys was saying that vaccination was the only real solution, as the number of new cases per day remained stubbornly high and infectious people were being active in their communities long enough to continue the spread of the disease. Vaccination rates were improving, but there were still many problems of supply and of distribution.

I had even revised our 'Mildura Meander' route run to stay in NSW until the very last moment, so that the Meander could happen whatever the border crossing situation might be. Even so, until the end of September I was doubtful whether we would be allowed to travel out of our local government areas, let alone cross the state almost to the SA border.

Since then, vaccinations have been going apace to the point where the NSW government is confidently planning the re-opening of the State and if not fully removing, at least significantly reducing the travel and social restrictions. It seemed that within a week we went from despairing of being able to leave our LGA, let alone travel around our state, to the current optimism about relaxing restrictions and allowing people to resume their normal lives. Even so far as to eat a meal at a pub or restaurant!



Gordon Lynas – 0403 198 343 – gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

So, the great news is that it looks like the Mildura Meander will be going ahead – our first face to face club event in many months.

Hopefully Victoria is also on a sufficiently similar trajectory to allow AHOC (Vic) to finally hold their National Rally (albeit in mini form) at Mildura in November. If that happens, the Mildura Meander

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COMMITTEE LIST - 2021

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Gordon Lynas
4 Wanari Road
Terrey Hills NSW 2084
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gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

Vice-President - Geoff Smith
0458 777 339
m.gpsmith@bigpond.com

Secretary - Julie Lee
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hedli@tpg.com.au

Treasurer - John Sherman
0419 976 844
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Social Secretary - Bruce Ewan
0432 096 493
bruce.ewan1@gmail.com

Editor - Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Rd.,
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(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p_cquinn@tpg.com.au

Historian - Joe Armour
0419 233 099
joea6@bigpond.com

Membership Secretary - Christine Lyttle
0410 201 373
membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Regalia - Colin Rule
0467 563 523
coolibahconvertible@bigpond.com

Technical Officer - Neville Stirton
0414 472 877
stirton@bigpond.net.au

Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn
(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
0412 898 656
mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ron Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Ian Clayton

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirton
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Warwick Sell, Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick Quinn, Terry Bancroft, Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 6494
North Ryde NSW 2113

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p_quinn@tpg.com.au

Greetings and welcome to the October 2021 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter.

It's been quiet hasn't it? With lockdown and all that means there has been nothing happening except for the occasional Zoom meeting. By the way I have noticed that no one has sent in the Zoom address for this week's meeting, so you will find that below.

Thank you so much to those members who have sent in a few words and pics of what they have been up to. Neil Janes for instance from the Central Coast who is rebuilding the engine of his BN7 Mk1 and has gone to the trouble to press fingers to the keyboard and took a few photos for us all to read and look at. Thank you Neil!

Thank you to Ray Roberts as well, who during a period of acute lockdown boredom wrote us some words on what sections of the Austin-Healey wiring harness could be enhanced by an additional fuse or two. Have you wondered about the family history connection

between Ron Strange and that of Greg and Dianne Strange? Thank you to Ronnie for sharing a letter between the extended Strange family.

If the minutes are too exciting for you, you might be interested in the BN4 I spied for sale in the US. While it does have its chassis plate, it's a good thing that replacements chassis are available. Thanks to Rick Neville in the US for the use of his article on the Austin-Healeys associated with the Great Train Robbery.

Why are Austin-Healeys sent to try us? I suppose it applies to any older car really, but tried I have really been of late. On page 18 I have included an article on how two small triangular pieces of rubber really tried my patience. Then late on a Sunday afternoon when I realised that I could not proceed further on that job I decided to remove the Austin-Healey badge from the boot lid. What could be simpler? At the back of the badge

there are three small lugs that fit through three holes in the boot lid and held in place by three clips. The clips were easy, but do you think the badge would budge? Then followed some judicious tapping with a small hammer.

Believe me the tapping was as judicious as possible. Finally the badge came away ----- as did a big patch of blue paint. It was certainly a 'not happy Jan' moment. When I had paintwork attended to a month or so back, it didn't include the rear shroud or boot lid. So I had to remove the bootlid and in doing that the paint around the leading edge of the right boot hinge was also damaged. I am soon to undertake another journey to the paintshop.

I will finish this editorial by asking you to read the vale for founding and life member Warwick Sell that you will find on page 13. Sad news!

Trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter and I look forward to receiving your photos and words.



<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/89690407645?pwd=SmJPNVQrRStnYko2bnRHRGlSSGp2dz09>

**Or just open Zoom and join:
Meeting ID: 896 9040 7645
Passcode: 297053**



Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 2 September 2021.

Commenced: 7:35pm.

Venue - Zoom Video Conference

ATTENDEES

Refer attendance list.

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

There were no new members, but Comet, Greg and Dianne's house cat, decided to put in an appearance as a visitor!

APOLOGIES

Patricia Bancroft, Glenn Barnes, Mal French, Andrew James, Garry Lee, Christine Lyttle, Greg Poole, Doug & Pamela Ross, Judy Sherman, Geoff Smith, Allan Whitehouse, and Charlie (Greg and Dianne's workshop cat!)

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 5 August 2021, as published in the September 2021 issue of Flat Chat, be verified as a correct record of that meeting.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Sadly, given the lack of social activity or events, Gordon didn't have much to talk about...

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

No report.

SECRETARY'S REPORT

Julie advised of snail mail received:

- The Australian Jaguar Driver – August

Electronic magazines and newsletters received:

- Rally Directions (CRC) – August
- Healey Torque (Qld) – September

Other emails received:

- An email from a former member, Peter Osborn, offering to donate five chrome spoke wire wheels from his old Austin-Healey 100 (but before John Sherman was able to pick them up, a friend of Peter's took them off his hands), and also wanting to pass on his regards to any long-time Club members that might remember him
- Request from a new Austin-Healey owner and potential member for help with finding someone in the Orange/Dubbo area to maintain his BN4.

- Advice that the Wagging Tails Community "Crooz and Chooz" Car Show at Lake George Vineyard, 24 October 2021 had been cancelled.

TREASURER'S REPORT

John advised of the Club's funds as at 31 August 2021:

Debit card	\$301.93
Main Account	\$23,185.06
Cash Reserve	\$12,500.28
Charlie's Run	\$2,944.07
Term Deposit	\$78,945.63
Interest Earned	\$0.12

Income for the month was for membership fees (\$1,340), sale of 2 windscreens (\$480) and Flat Chat advertising (\$250).

The only payment was \$2,020 for Issue 28 of *Australian Austin-Healey*. John advised that Jim Phillips had developed a simplified calculation for the national magazine costs, being a flat rate of \$10 per magazine within Australia and \$15 outside of Australia. All advertising money contributed to the cost of producing the magazine. Any surplus funds would be returned to each of the Clubs in proportion to the number of magazines paid for.

During the month, John and Colin Rule had done a stocktake of windscreens available for sale.

SOCIAL SECRETARY'S REPORT

Bruce advised that 17 October was supposed to be the approximate date where NSW would start to relax restrictions, so he was hoping that the visit to Highfield Gardens on 7 November would be able to go ahead. Having said that, it would overlap with the Mildura Mini-Rally, so Bruce was to see if Highfield might be able to open on the third weekend in November.

Bruce planned on recycling this year's calendar into 2022 and hoped to have a full schedule available by late November. He was looking for technical workshop venues for the year.

On behalf of the Club, Gordon thanked Bruce for his perseverance in the face of constant delays and cancellations.

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

No report

**WEBMASTER'S REPORT**

Jim advised that he now had a car advertised on the website, so he was gradually getting that side of things ramped up. He asked any members with things to sell to let him know the details – he'd also put something in Flat Chat to let everyone know. He'd also created a new website section on technical resources, so wanted to spread the word that this was available.

MEMBERSHIP

No report

EDITOR'S REPORT

Patrick was pleased to report no bounce-backs and was also very grateful to the members who'd contributed five stories to the magazine.

REGISTRAR

Patrick advised there'd been a few more HVS renewals but a few had also dropped off his list as they hadn't renewed their Club memberships. Each had been advised by Patrick of the impact of their membership having lapsed, so it was up to those individuals to do something about their car's registration.

Bruce thanked Patrick for that fantastic job he was doing with producing the newsletter

HISTORIAN

No report

LIBRARIAN

No report

**TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/
SPARE PARTS**

No report.

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

Ross said he'd received an email from Parramatta Park wanting to know if the Club was still interested in holding the Show and Shine. He'd responded saying that the proposed September date was out, but for them to keep 24 October in mind.

CMC REPORT

Ray didn't have any CMC news, but told an entertaining story of driving his 100S back from an AHOC meeting one night and being out-dragged

by a former partner of Geoff Edelstein, in her pink Porsche (numberplate 2Hot4U!). Some five years later, he ran into her at a panel beating shop, where she was the partner of the owner.

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

No report

CSCA REPORT

Colin advised most emphatically that he had nothing to report!

REGALIA

Colin asked for views on whether he should order more windscreens, but after discussion, it was agreed he should hold off until there was enough demand for a larger order.

FOR SALE/WANTED

Nothing. Nada. Zilch.

GENERAL BUSINESS

- Terry advised there were still vacancies for the Tassie tour.
- Colin Rule asked for suggestions on moving a car up to Port Macquarie.
- Bruce asked for an indication on who was fully vaccinated, as this would have a bearing on events post lockdown.
- Bruce thought that the Club had a tentative booking for the Christmas Party at Strathfield Golf Club, but John Wakeling advised that the caterers had apparently left, so that needed follow up.
- Gordon advised that he'd had no recent news from the Victorian Club about the Mildura Mini-Rally. Gordon had amended his Mildura Meander so that it was now wholly within NSW. He also hadn't heard anything more from the WA Club about the 2024 National Rally.
- John Thornton advised that a red Austin-Healey which was for sale through The Healey Factory (for \$125K) was the same car which Colin Rule had restored for him 30 years ago, and it was still looking very good!
- Alan Mitchell lamented his continuing internet woes...

Colin Rule expressed concern about John Kent and Peter Jackson coming up from Melbourne for concours judging. It was noted that there were three judges in NSW (Patrick Quinn, Ian Clayton and

Minutes cont'

Allan Whitehouse), so it was suggested that judging sessions could be organised with them. Colin responded that apparently John was champing at the bit to come up to NSW for the judging, so he would wait and see if it could be organised for November or December first before pulling the pin.

There was discussion on the process for renewing cars on the HVS, given COVID restrictions. Patrick advise that if members were unable to renew their

rego at their local Service NSW office, they could send the rego papers to the postal address in Parkes – the Parkes office would then ring to get credit card details for the payment.

Patrick also confirmed that a car on HVS registration could be used within the same restrictions as any other registered car.

Meeting concluded at 8:45pm

President's Message Cont'

der will actually get to Mildura, but I'm not counting that chicken quite just yet. I do sincerely hope that the mini-rally happens as it would be just too dispiriting for the Victorian club having twice cancelled their National Rally already.

Not only can we look forward to travelling around in our Austin-Healeys, but it looks very probable that the October General Meeting might be the final Zoom meeting (fingers fully crossed). Watch Flat Chat for confirmation, but I'm expecting to be presiding over the November General Meeting at the Strathfield Golf Club. Not only that, but after many postponements it looks like our social programme will also be getting into full swing, so get your Austin-Healeys or other classic car ready for socialising with the club. It's going

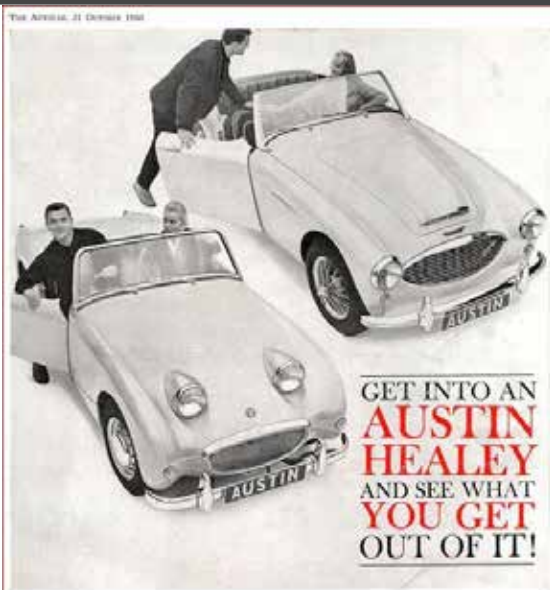
to be great to see a line of Austin-Healeys parading through the state once more.

November 4th will also be our Annual General Meeting where we elect the management committee for the club for the coming year. The committee are always happy to welcome new members join them in keeping the club going and events happening, so if you can do so, please think about taking up a role to keep this great club functioning. If you are not sure about what roles there are, just have a look at the minutes of any general meeting as published in Flat Chat each month.

See you at Strathfield soon, and maybe even at Mildura.

Happy Healeying
Gordon Lynas

The AUSTIN, 21 October 1960



**GET INTO AN
AUSTIN
HEALEY
AND SEE WHAT
YOU GET
OUT OF IT!**

THERE'S no one way to describe the Austin Healeys. There couldn't be. For the Austin Healeys are so many brilliant things at once. They are powerful, vigorous cars. Briskly, they take you in and out of corners. Swiftly, surely they surge out ahead on the long, open road. Yet high sustained speeds are only one result of their exceptional power. For the Austin Healeys are like and agile too. They slip through traffic with impudent ease; park themselves neatly in the tightest vacant lot. These are the Austin Healeys – real sportsman's cars.

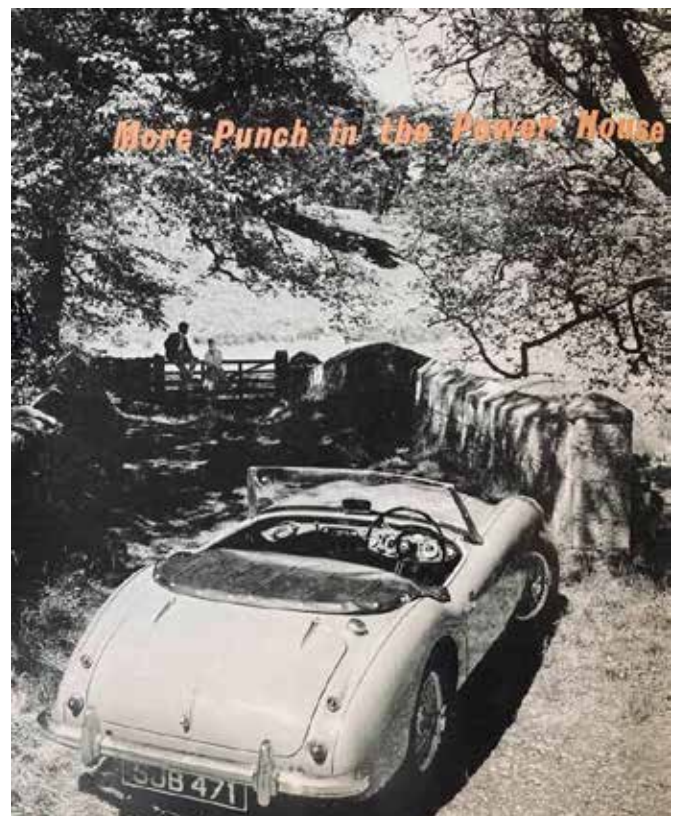
Austin Healey 200 Luxurious 2- or occasional 4-seater sports car. Robust 6-cylinder, 2992 cc engine. Top speed over 100 mph. One stroke fitted to match its performance.

Austin Healey 2500 Energetic 2-seater sports car. Fast yet docile. An economical yet potent.

And yours for a price that's quite inconceivable. 6445 gives 8165-10-10 P.T. See the Austin Healeys at the Motor Show. Look over them. Look into them. And ask you nearest Austin distributor for a free trial ride.

AUSTIN LOOKS YEARS AHEAD

THE AUSTIN MOTOR COMPANY LIMITED LONGBRIDGE BIRMINGHAM



We have no new members this month. Although we have had an enquiry to buy an Austin-Healey and we have sent the encouragement to them to join as an Associate until the correct car comes up for sale.

The General Meeting once again will be held by Zoom due to Covid-19 lockdown. As you all know the General Meeting is this Thursday 7 October and the link to remind you will be in Flat Chat. With the impending end to lockdown we can hope for a face-to-face Annual General Meeting in November 2021.

It is with much sadness to hear of the passing of Warwick Sell on Sunday 3 October 2021. Sincere condolences go to Jennifer and sons Cameron and Lincoln and their wives Belinda and Karina and grandchildren. Warwick was one of the founding life members of the club and was involved in the club from 1969 and Warwick and Jennifer both worked tirelessly on the committee in the early years until their sons were born and when they were involved in family commitments. They came back to racing events when Cameron took an interest in driving in competition. Warwick is our second life member to pass away in the 52 years of the club. Rest in Peace Warwick.

Membership Report Christine Lyttle

0410 201 373

membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au



This month on the 15th is the first anniversary of the passing of Anne Read, a member that we all miss very much. Our thoughts go to Don Read on this anniversary.

Remember, we can only have your correct details, if you advise us and update them. So please keep me advised of your changes eg phone numbers, email addresses and home address. Please send any changes to membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au I noticed that there are a lot of photographs added to members on the website. Thanks for taking the time to view the website.

Keep safe and well!
Happy Healeying
Christine Lyttle

Social Report

Bruce Ewan

0432 096 493

bruce.ewan1@gmail.com

With NSW and greater Sydney coming out of lockdown October 11, social activities and gatherings can begin again. Let's hope that further lockdowns are not imposed.

At the time of distributing Flat Chat a technical workshop for October would not be permitted.

Social Activities will be added for November so please visit the Austin Healey NSW Event page for activities as we get closer to November.

<https://www.austinhealeynsw.com.au/events/>

FOR SALE

Austin-Healey Handbooks

ORIGINAL not repro.

- 100/6 Owners handbook original 1957: "aged" good condition
- 100/6 Owners handbook MINT BOXED Feb1958
- 100/6 Owners handbook MINT May 1957
- 3000/Mk 111 BJ8 Owners Handbook BMC 1966
- Austin Healey 3000 BN7 BT7 Mk11 Supplement to handbook (two copies)
- Austin Healey Sprite Mk1 drivers handbook 1964
- Austin Healey Sprite Mk 1 & 2 drivers handbook AKD1627B, & AKD1627D
- Austin Healey Sprite Mk111 (finger marks)

FOR SALE

FOR SALE

Honest Offers. If interested please contact Phil Whitton on 0404 322 139



Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

A relatively active month with new registrations and five or so renewals per week.

One call from a member concerned placing an additional number of vehicles on Historic Vehicle Registration over and above the two he already had. He was concerned that it was taking advantage of the system. He was assured that it certainly wasn't taking advantage and in fact that's what the system is all about. By all means, he was encouraged to place as many vehicles as he wanted on Historic Vehicles

Registration. Currently we have 204 vehicles on Historic Vehicle Registration and of these 119 are marque vehicles. Most are individual vehicles owned by a single member, but we have one member who is well into double figures and some not far behind.

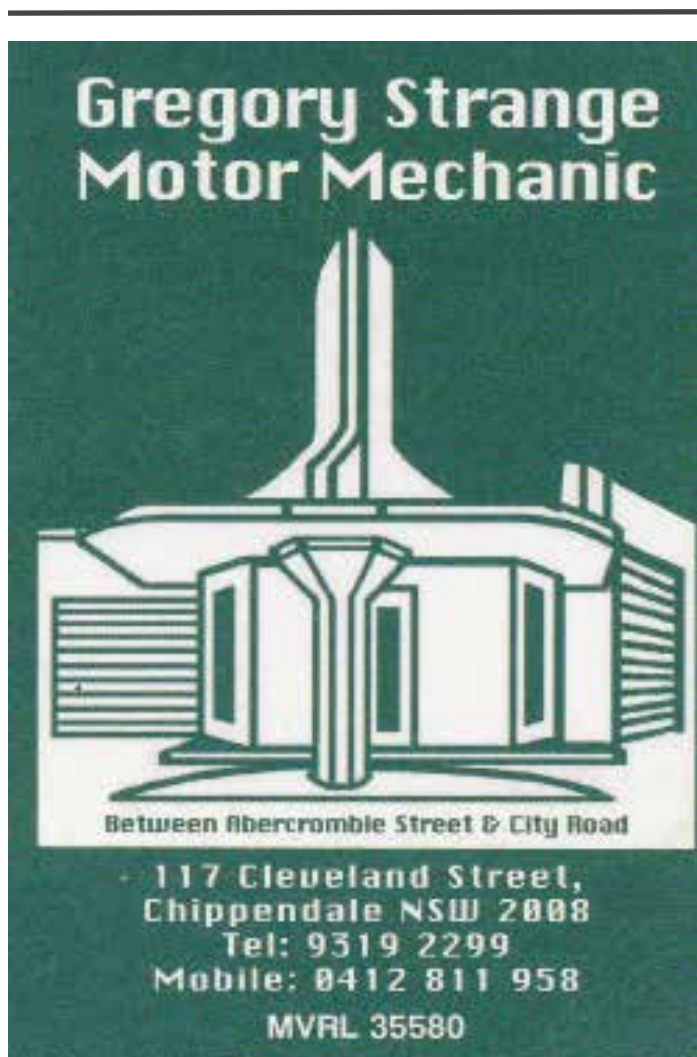
An aspect that have arisen during the last month is the application and renewals of Historic Vehicle Registrations. I have heard stories about enthusiasts attempting to make a fresh application at a Services NSW office only to be told that what they were doing did not coming under the definition of an 'essential service'. Similarly some haven't been able to renew for the same reason. Such information has been received purely on a hearsay basis, so it may be just a scary story.

However the following three pages are a communication received from Transport for NSW that refers to the renewal of both Classic and Historic Vehicle Registration. I have read it three or four times and can't say I find it perfectly clear. Have a close read, but remember all appropriate vehicles in the AHOC are registered as Historic Vehicles, except for one. So you can safely ignore the reference to Classic Vehicles.

I think that on reading the document once again the important paragraph states *that Service NSW Centres are open to support customers with essential services only. As historic and classic vehicles are often a recreational or a secondary vehicle that can only be used a specific number of times per year; renewing registration is likely to be classified as a non-essential transaction.*

So what does it all mean? Well I think it depends on what side of the bed the Services NSW person got

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**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580



Conditional Registration

Renewal of classic and historic vehicle registration

Classic and historic vehicle registration renewals during COVID-19

To protect the community and help slow the spread of COVID-19, Transport for NSW in collaboration with Service NSW have implemented a number of temporary measures to assist customers.

Service NSW Centres are open to support customers with [essential services](#) only. As per the stay-at-home order, if a transaction is not essential, customers are advised that they should delay their visit to a service centre. As historic and classic vehicles are often a recreational or a secondary vehicle that can only be used a specific number of times per year, renewing registration is likely to be classified as a non-essential transaction.

As classic and historical vehicle registrations are **unable** to be renewed online, Transport for NSW has made the following temporary changes to assist customers with registration renewal of their classic and historic vehicles:

- If the registration of a classic vehicle due between 28 June and 31 October 2021 has expired more than 3 months, customers can get a Safety Check (Pink Slip) rather than the usual Unregistered Vehicle Inspection (blue slip) Report required to re-establish the registration. This is only available to classic cars whose registration expired during that specific time period. Safety Checks will be valid for 6 months.
- If a classic or historic vehicle is the **only** vehicle owned, and is a customer's primary mode of transport and the customer has documentation that illustrates this, they can attend a Service NSW Centre to renew their registration.
- If a safety inspection of a classic vehicle is due between 28 June and 31 October 2021, customers can get a Safety Check (Pink Slip) rather than the usual Unregistered Vehicle Inspection (blue slip) Report. This is only available to classic cars whose registration expired during that specific time period. Safety Checks will be valid for 6 months.
- Registration establishment or renewal for historic vehicles is the [same as the current process](#). Customers can renew their historic vehicle registration and retain their existing plate, at no additional cost for keeping the same plate.
- Registration can be renewed by post. Customers can send a cheque or credit card authority, registration renewal notice and relevant declaration to: Service NSW, PO Box 21, Parkes, NSW, 2870.
- For further information go to <https://www.nsw.gov.au/topics/vehicle-registration/conditional-and-seasonal/conditional-change>



Conditional Registration Renewal of classic and historic vehicle registration during COVID-19

Classic and historic vehicle – conditional registration renewals

Due to the current restrictions in NSW, we have had to make some changes to the way you renew your classic and historic registration.

What do I do if my registration has expired?

If your registration has expired since 28 June 2021, or is due to expire before 31 October 2021, you do not have to renew your registration. However, once it has expired, your vehicle will have a registration status of "suspended". This means you can not drive your vehicle and you must adhere to all restrictions placed on an unregistered vehicle. The "suspended" status will last for 3 months. During this time, you can [still renew your vehicle's registration](#). However, after the 3 month suspended period has ended, your registration will be cancelled as per normal process.

What if my vehicle is my only form of transport?

If your classic or historic vehicle is the only vehicle you own, and is your primary mode of transport, and you can provide documentation that illustrates this, you can still renew your registration. If you attend a Service NSW centre and notify the customer service representative, your transaction will be processed.

How do I renew my *classic vehicle* registration if it has expired?

If your registration expires between 28 June and 31 October 2021, you will be able to obtain a Safety Check (Pink Slip) rather than the usual Unregistered Vehicle Inspection (blue slip) Report. This process is only available to classic cars whose registration expired during that specific time period.

You are only permitted to drive your unregistered vehicle on a public road to obtain the Safety Check or for another purpose directly associated with the registration process. Once you have received the Safety Check, you will be able to renew your vehicle registration with the existing plate, at no additional cost for keeping the same plate.



Conditional Registration Renewal of classic and historic vehicle registration during COVID-19

How do I renew my *historic vehicle* registration if it has expired?

Registration establishment or renewal for historic vehicles is the [same as the current process](#).

You will be able to renew your vehicle registration with the existing plate, at no additional cost for keeping the same plate.

How can I pay my registration once restrictions have eased?

Classic and historical vehicle registration cannot be renewed online. If you attend a Service NSW centre, notify the customer service representative and your transaction will be processed.

You can also renew your registration by post. Send your cheque or credit card authority, registration renewal notice and relevant declaration to: Service NSW, PO Box 21, Parkes, NSW 2870.

Will the registration date change?

If you renew your registration **within** 3 months of the expiry date, the registration period will be effective from the original date of expiry.

If you renew your registration **after** 3 months from the expiry date, the registration period will commence from the date of the transaction.

Will I be able to keep the same plates?

You will be able to use the same plates when renewing the registration of your classic or historic vehicle at no additional cost.

For further information go to <https://www.nsw.gov.au/topics/vehicle-registration/conditional-and-seasonal/conditional-change>

For queries and comments please email IndustryEngagement@transport.nsw.gov.au

Webmaster's Report

by Jim Phillips



There have been a few things going on in the background with the developer of the site. It's expected that it will make it a little easier to keep in touch with members' details and it would be good if members were to access their details (let me know if you are experiencing troubles or have forgotten your password) and confirm if your contact details are correct.

While you are at looking at your contact details, please also have a look at the cars that are shown. Details of members' vehicles are added to the database of vehicles after our cars had been initially loaded onto the website. If your car is not showing, either click on the link to add a vehicle or click on edit for your car that is showing. Click on the

"change" option and then locate your vehicle from the options presented.

One of the benefits of using the MYCCO hosting platform, is that the website is designed for car clubs and although it is not a full-time job for the host, he is open to changes once they have been suggested. We do not have the benefit of changes made just for our club, but one of the latest add-ons currently being developed has our social secretary excited in that it will give you the ability to RSVP for events via the website. Watch this space for details.

Always happy to help members get connected to the website and to receive your input on how it can be made better

Historic Vehicle Reg. cont'

up in the morning. However just to be safe I would suggest that you think about posting away your renewal to the Parkes NSW address that can be found on your renewal form. For payment you can send a cheque, if you still have one of those or send a credit card authority that can be found here:-

<https://roads-waterways.transport.nsw.gov.au/documents/about/forms/45071058-pay-your-registration.pdf>

I recently did just that for the Quinn Healey and just after a week it all came back to me. This of course meant that I didn't have to stand in a queue at my local Services NSW which is about 20 minutes from my home.

Please remember the steps when renewing your Historic Vehicle Registration:-

- Once you have received the renewal, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of *Flat Chat* for their contact details.
- Complete the left hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.

Vale Warwick Sell



It is with sadness that we advise of the death of founding and life member Warwick Sell on Sunday 3 October after a lengthy illness.

Warwick Sell and girlfriend Jennifer were there from before the beginning of our club. The formation of the AHOC from nothing is not as straightforward as you would imagine. Along with Don Read and Alan Jones, it was Warwick and Jennifer who gathered together Sydney Austin-Healey owners at Oran Park and discussed the prospects of starting a club for Austin-Healey owners in New South Wales.

It was Warwick and Jennifer who would spend their weekends travelling all over Sydney to the homes of prospective club members and inviting them to

the first meeting at the BMC Theatrette at Zetland. Later it was Warwick and Jennifer who administered the all-important club documentation that held the fledgling AHOC together during those early formative years.

Warwick and Jennifer would shortly afterwards become the Sells and attention was turned to the growth of the family business. However the interest in vehicles associated with the Donald Healey Motor Company was always at the forefront of Warwick's mind. With sons Cameron and Lincoln the enthusiasm was passed on and they too became AHOC members.

Over time, a 100 and a 3000 Mk1 were parked in the Sell garage along with a Healey Silverstone and Elliott. During the 1990s the Sells added 1953 Le Mans 100 NOJ 392 to the stable, after having it restored by The Healey Factory.

While a very private person, Warwick however was not blinkered when it came to his pursuits. Other marques of interest included Riley, Rover, Ford and Mopar as well as steam powered vehicles.

Warwick Sell has been a member of the AHOC from 9 March 1969, the earliest date possible. We have lost another foundation and life member. I am sure that I speak for everyone when I extended our greatest condolences to Jennifer, Cameron, Lincoln and families.



Ralph Fletcher Photo

Electrical Protection for Your Austin-Healey

by Ray Roberts

While I am bored with the lockdown (8/2021) I decided to write this fodder. I am now in meltdown.

I have been part of the British car scene since 1947 starting with my Dad's 1937 Austin Wasp, then a Morris Minor fleet car of Sydney County Council and lucky work mates owning Austin-Healeys (Paul Keating being one), then finally my own Austin-Healeys.

All these cars had basically the same wiring system so much so, as apprentices we had to be able to draw the wiring diagram from memory.

I have noticed when owners restore their cars they like to add extra electrical protection via relays and fuses. Over the years I have seen only two types of failures that cause significant damage to the wiring harness, which lets the Lucas smoke escape.

This is what I would do:

1. The rear number plate light, caused by both positive and negative connections looking similar, is so easy to connect up wrong. Therefore I would fuse this circuit.

2. If you replace the generator with an alternator, the electrical mistake that can be here is reversing the battery during replacement or when getting a jump start, this can happen in a split second.

What is needed here is an inline fuse in the large wire going to the alternator (most modern cars have). The bridge rectifier in alternators is a dead short circuit when the battery is reversed; the inline fuse's job is to protect the wiring.

PS Generators are quite reliable with replacement of electrical brushes every 20,000 miles.



Tasmania Tour - 2022

At the request of the AHOC I have been asked to organise another Tasmania Tour in 2022.

If you wish to express your interest, please contact Terry Bancroft on 0409 323 133, or (02) 4777 4883 or bangers@bancroft.id.au

You may pull out up to around December 2021 with nil loss.

This will definitely be the last Tasmania Tour that Pat and I will be organising.

Itinerary

February 6th -	Departing Melbourne on the Spirit of Tasmania
February 7th -	Breakfast at the Edgewater Hotel Devonport
February 7th & 8th -	Overnight stay in Burnie
February 9th & 10th -	Overnight at the West Coaster Motel Queenstown
February 11th-14th -	Overnight at the Old Wool Store, Hobart
February 15th & 16th -	Overnight Bicheno
February 17th & 18th -	Overnight Casino Launceston
February 19th -	Depart Devonport for Melbourne on the Spirit of Tasmania

All mornings will include either a continental or a full breakfast depending on where we are.

Letter from Ron Strange

Dear Gregory and Dianne Strange

On my last visit to your historic premises back in the middle of the year, we failed to get my brakes to stop properly and agreed to attack the issue at a later time.

We did however establish that day when your ancient predecessors sailed from England to Sydney in the early 19th century and not only that, but they PAID THEIR OWN FARE! (Believe that and you'd believe anything). My predecessor however sailed here some years earlier, but in his case it was ALL EXPENSES PAID! (Some misunderstanding with a bank)

At that time you expertly identified the noise in the brake master cylinder as not that of a woodpecker and decided a replacement would be a good idea. Similarly, you detected the rear brake hose was fitted some years earlier, like 1961, and should be in a museum.

You have ordered these parts along with a new shiny screw top for the fluid reservoir, I'm looking forward to getting them all fitted.

Not sure how the supplier in Victoria reacted to the request for something called a MASTER cylinder. Fortunately we didn't need a SLAVE cylinder or we may have had some explaining to do.

With the current COVID restrictions I'm only allowed to drive five trillion centipedes or something. Going to Dan Murphy's is not a problem in that respect but with the brakes not working I overshot the turning and had to do a u-turn. Going uphill was easier and the turn was made without the use of brakes.

Greg, if you prefer I could call in to one of your many branches; I can legally drive to your branch at the northern end of Wynyard Park or the southern end of Hyde; both are within the five thingies, but alas I can't go all the way to Cleveland Street Chippendale.

There lies another potential problem, with Chippendale being within Sydney's Nuclear Free Zone I would be prevented from driving my Austin-Healey anywhere near there.

As you know I converted my car to ELECTRIC some time ago and, keeping up with the Joneses, I recently I converted it to run on URANIUM I get from George at the local Shoe Repair & Key Cutting Shop. George's shop however isn't classed as an essential business and he is shut just like my barber and they have all gone on holiday to Lebanon anyway.

I'm saving up to put a deposit down on a few gallons of Premium Petrol just in case I have to convert the car back to original.

I have watched in awe, standing in Military Road seeing long distance buses going to exotic destinations, faraway places such as the CBD, Wynyard and even the QVB are reachable, I'm still not allowed to drive a car that far!

Greg, our desire to get my car fixed was ambushed at the pass by government stuff earlier this year but we'll overcome that soon. When you have time to do your wizardry and spanner spinning, give me a call and I'll drive the 8.5 km legally to your garage.

Regards to you both. Ronnie



1962 mock funeral for a pair of undergraduates sent down (thrown out) at Cambridge University.

Engine Rebuild Progress - Part 2

by Neil Janes



It's now eight months since the engine came out of my BN7 and I can report some progress since my last update.

The Hepolite pistons (+.020 in) arrived from Canada after a four week wait and were immediately dropped off at the engine machinists (Easy Motors at Tuggerah). They had been waiting on them so that each cylinder could be bored and honed to each individual piston. The crankshaft was machined and balanced and new oversized bearings used. A rear main seal conversion kit was also installed.

The old camshaft (with worn lobes) was sent to Clive Cams in Melbourne along with a damaged camshaft from Ian Richter's performance engine which had been lying around in his shed. Unfortunately neither of the camshafts was suitable to

be ground to a 'warm' performance grind so Clive (from Clive Cams) sourced a suitable second hand AH 3000 camshaft from a colleague and submitted it to a custom grind. His instructions were for fast road specifications, but still easy to drive around town. We won't know how well he has achieved this until the car is back on the road.

The head has received a major overhaul. The valves and springs were not in bad shape, but since Ian Richter had some new performance valves and springs along with collets and guides also lying around in his shed, we decided it would be a shame not to use them.

The engine is back with Steve Bromfield (ex-head mechanic at the Central Coast Motor Museum) and has had the pistons installed, head attached and new



Cont' next
page

water pump along with a new timing chain and tensioner and a complete set of new gaskets. The dented sump has been panel beaten back to good-as-new and the whole assembly is almost ready for paint. I have a set of headers and sports muffler (also from Ian's shed) to attach, when the engine is back in the car.

My current problem is that when the mechanic removed the engine from the car he was forced to destroy the capillary tube from the water temperature gauge, so I am trying to find someone who will replace the tube on an otherwise perfectly good gauge.

We are yet to have a look inside the gearbox, and the suspension bushes all need to be replaced prior to going back on the road, but at least it appears to be a lot closer to being driveable than it was when I last wrote.





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Why is it so?

by Patrick Quinn

It's was going to be easy. What could be difficult about fitting a small triangular flat piece of rubber under a shaped aluminium casting? Why is it so?

I had removed the reflector pods from the rear shroud of the Quinn Austin-Healey so the shroud could be buffed. According to available records such reflector pods (complete with reflectors) were fitted to four-cylinder Austin-Healeys from about August 1954 which is the same time when the Austin of England boot badge was changed to Austin-Healey. No doubt the reflectors were added to abide by some change in legislation that required they be fitted.

A few years back I had purchased two of the rubber pads that fit between the pod and shroud. They were listed as left and right, but looked exactly the same to me.

Well there goes a Sunday afternoon! No way would they fit as clearly they were too small.

Always believe in phoning a friend and both Colin Rule and George Goodare recommended cutting the rubber. I cut the edges and despite using copious amounts of slippery washing up liquid, there was no success, except to damage one of the pads.

I wrote to AH Spares in the UK letting them know of my lack of success and that in no circumstances were the rubber pads handed or would fit. They kindly reimbursed the cost of both pads by way of a credit note. Two new pads came from The Healey Factory.

In the meantime Colin Rule found a note he had received from Roger Moment explaining how the rubber pads could be made more pliable. So armed with a set of hole punches and a Stanley knife I set forth and modified the new pads.

Even with the modifications and still more washing liquid, each took over a half hour to fit, but fit they did.



After my first attempt. Managed to damage the one of the right. Complete pad on left.



New set of pads modified to be more pliable



Woo Hoo! It's fitted.



Complete reflector

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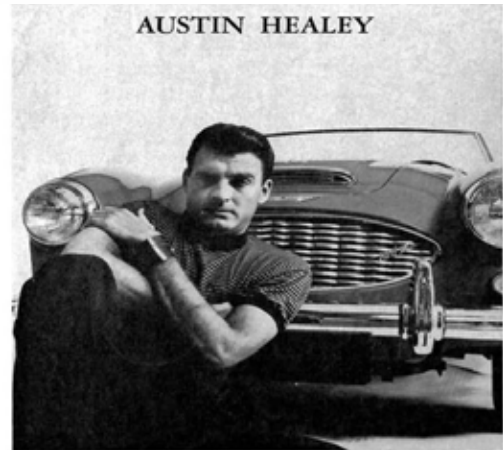
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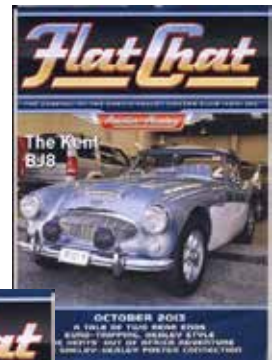
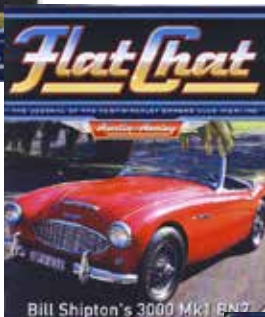
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Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Road
Kurrajong Heights
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (& stamp) at a meeting.



Is all hope lost?

You would have to wonder how an Austin-Healey ends up being like this BN4.

It's advertised in the US by the Beverly Hills Car Club, which is a fancy name for a car dealer located in Los Angeles. It's a dealer, with many of its vehicles for sale seeming ripe for restoration. There is the occasional 'drive home' vehicle, but the Austin-Healeys for sale do need a little lick of polish.

This car advertised as a 1958 Austin-Healey 100-6 BN4 Convertible Sports Car and we are told that it

has recently been discovered and comes equipped with a manual transmission, soft top frame, wire wheels, and side curtains. It's labelled as a British classic with tremendous potential for a full restoration.

What are they asking for it?

US\$9,750 which is the equivalent of Aus\$13,200.

What do you think?



Surely it will all polish out in an hour or two.



PRESS RELEASE

A H Spares Continues Investment in Tooling and Quality

As a company involved in Austin-Healeys since 1972, we have acquired a wealth of knowledge and experience regarding Austin-Healey body panels and sheet metal products, and the difficulties in sourcing them.

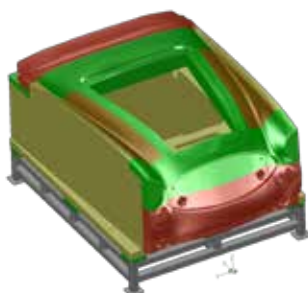
Recognising a gap in the market, A H Spares set up their sheet metal manufacturing unit, A H Panels in 2003 to ensure the products we supply are of consistent high quality. Our time-served craftsmen are highly skilled in all aspects of sheet metal fabrication including wheeling, jig chasing, coach building, Tig and Mig welding.

We continue to invest in A H Panels by working through our tooling and jigs, ensuring all are correct so products are produced to the best quality. To do this, we have scanned several original cars so CAD designs could be drawn up and analysed before we continued with the tooling. We then used reverse engineering to design the tools necessary to manufacture our body panels. Tolerances and alignments were assessed ensuring that our panels would fit together without much need of adjustment.

So far we have produced new tooling for our 3000 bonnet, rear shroud (with interchangeable sides so we can produce BJ7 and BJ8 from one tool) and for the 100/6 and 3000 front shroud. These have been surfaced and introduced to the moulds; ensuring effective tools so that the manufacturing function is correct, product lifecycle is extended and makes for a higher quality product overall.

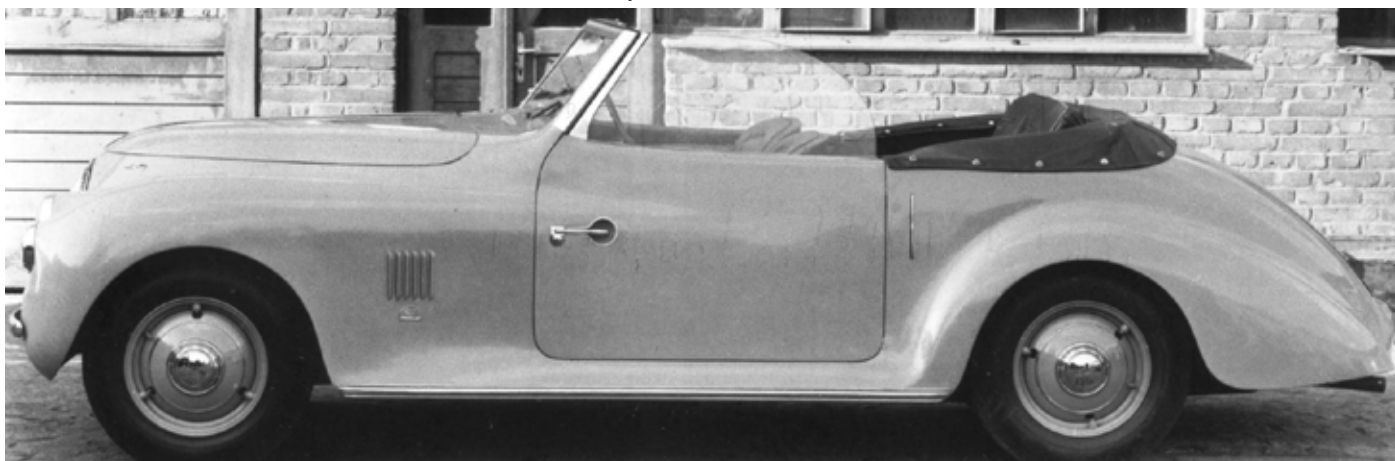
Over the past couple of years we have been devoting our time to manufacturing inner bodies for the Austin-Healey which are now in production. Our future goal is to supply and fully panelled Austin-Healey bodyshell in the coming months. Watch this space!!!!

By combining the latest technology and equipment with traditional metal working practices, we can fabricate practically anything guaranteeing high quality parts for the Austin-Healey Spares market.



Czech Healey

By Patrick Quinn



We last looked at this interesting Healey way back in the December 2010 – January 2011 issue of *Flat Chat*. A few weeks back a further photo of the car turned up in my inbox, prompting a revisit.

The initial photos were sent to me around 2007 back by a gentleman by the name of Jan Kralik in the Czech Republic. He was a motoring writer and researching for a book on the Czech motoring industry and in particular a coachbuilder by the name of Oldrich Uhlik in Prague.

Formed in 1921, Oldrich Uhlik went on to build bodies for high end manufacturers like Bugatti, Rolls-Royce, Hispano Suiza, Isotta-Fraschini, Voisin, Mercedes-Benz and of course the Czech built Tatra. On a more commercial basis Oldrich Uhlik also built bodies for heavier vehicles such as were being used by the Czech postal service.

Known simply as the 2.4 litre Roadster, the first Healey was launched in 1946 to wide acclaim. As we know, bodies available directly from the Donald Healey Motor Company were the saloon style called the Elliott and the Westland roadster.

However the Healey rolling chassis was also available for those who wished to choose their own coachbuilder



or for individual coachbuilders who wished to produce a car for sale. Of the total 1,185 Healey chassis built, some 123 were sold as rolling chassis.

In 1947 the fledgling Donald Healey Motor Company took a stand at the Paris Motor Show exhibiting an early Elliott and a rolling chassis as well as a Duncan pillar-less saloon.

The Paris Motor Show was a success for the DHMC, and soon after Swiss coachbuilder Beuttler offered their own bodies on the Healey chassis. We also know that Oldrich Uhlik was at Paris and signed a contract for the production of 200 Healey rolling chassis that would be fitted with Czech sporting bodies.

It is not known how many were eventually built, but from the photo there was at least one. February 1948 saw a coup d'état when the Communist Party of Czechoslovakia, with Soviet backing took control of the country. Just one month later businesses such as Oldrich Uhlik's were nationalised and producing bodies for cars such as the Healey were outlawed.

It is not known what happened to the Oldrich Uhlik bodied Healey.



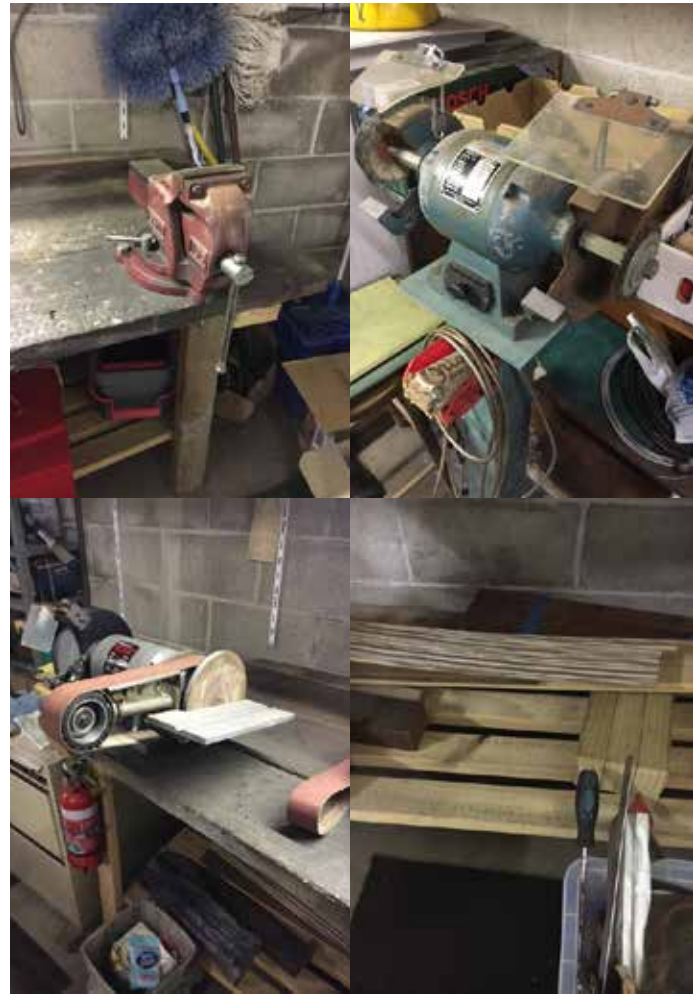
FOR SALE

Philip Bloom offers the following for sale on behalf of ex-member Tony Williams.

If interested Philip can be contacted on 0425 363 469

- Workbench 57in x 102in x 37in high complete with vice.
- Buff and wire brush
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- Set allen keys metric and SAE
- Taps and dies set whitworth
- BN1 diff in good condition BN1 suit restoration \$300
- Vacuum gauge to check carbs \$30

Philip also offers for sale - one 2 inch SU \$300 each and four x 1 3/4 SU \$250 each



Stock photo

Neville Stirton Offers the following for Sale

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Thanks to Rick Neville for allowing us to
republish the following four pages.



AUCTION REPORT

Rick Neville
HEALEY MARQUE
AUCTION REPORTER

Austin-Healey, a flash motor! ... for criminals?

When a London lad came into a few quid during the Swinging Sixties, he'd likely buy himself a flash motor to celebrate. The lads in our story scored more than a few pounds, 2.6 million to be precise, and their flash motor of choice? Austin-Healey.

They were the robbers who waylaid an overnight Royal Mail train from Glasgow to London on August 8, 1963, and looted a High Valued Packets coach of mailbags containing about \$56 million in today's money.

The enterprise became known as "The Great Train Robbery," a.k.a. "The Crime of the Century," and the robbers, of which there were 18 in toto, were romanticized as Robin Hoods of their time, stealing what was all "bank money" from "the Establishment."

Make no mistake though, the gang was made up of true villains who, unlike Robin Hood, kept the money for themselves and not for the poor. And the crime was hardly nonviolent, as the train engineer who was coshed on the head during the robbery never returned to work and died seven years later probably due to complications from his injuries.

The mastermind of the raid was Bruce Reynolds, a south Londoner who decided early on that his career path would be professional criminal. To Reynolds, dressing well, being seen at the right places, and driving a proper motorcar were all signs that he was doing well in his chosen profession.

"I had always had a fascination with cars, ever since I hero-worshipped racing drivers as a kid. To me, a sports car was the ultimate status symbol," Reynolds said in his book, *Autobiography of a Thief*. But that didn't mean he always picked up his latest ride legitimately. "All the old cars had a Lucas ignition which operated on a simple rectangular key that could be replaced by virtually any strip of metal. Without any pressure, a screwdriver could be pushed in or even a stiff piece of foil. This made them ridiculously easy to steal. Later they introduced a coded key system as a security measure. This, too, was ludicrously easy because the key details were often printed on the dashboard or the ignition and you could actually read them from outside the car."

Reynolds started hanging out at a pub called the Star in Belgravia where he began dressing the part in bespoke shoes by John Lobb, shirts from Jermyn Street, and suits from Savile Row. Combined with his black heavy-rimmed glasses, his look was said to have inspired Michael Caine's appearance as spy Harry Palmer in the *Ipcress Files*. Amongst the film stars, directors, gangsters, and petty thieves that made

the Star their haunt was the motor racing crowd, consisting of Grand Prix legends like Mike Hawthorn and Peter Collins.



Bruce Reynolds.



Actor Michael Caine looking very much the part.

His contacts helped him snag a year-old Aston-Martin DB24 prepared for Les Leston for Monte Carlo for just under £1,100.

In 1957, Reynolds said his priorities were "crime, cars and crumpet," and the Aston was joined by a Porsche that he picked up from the factory at Stuttgart and which three weeks later he put into a brick wall while driving to Le Mans with his girlfriend, Rita. One of his many stints in prison followed and Rita left him, but undaunted he celebrated his release by immediately taking Rita's younger sister, Franny, to a hotel



The spoils of a life of crime. Reynolds with Franny in a flash sports car.

room in Jersey in a hired Bugeye Sprite for a week's debauch. A new Triumph TR soon followed, but after a series of misadventures and accidents, Reynolds dumped the car feeling it was nothing but bad luck.

His next sports car came after his future brother-in-law and Great Train Robber, John "Paddy" Daly, ordered a coming-home present for himself upon his release from a prison stint in 1961 ... a customized racing Healey.

According to his autobiography, Reynolds said it "growled like a rabid dog and seemed to be rocket propelled." After giving Daly's car a "bit of stick," Reynolds proclaimed it a "seriously fast car that created a whiplash effect among pedestrians turning their heads to catch a glimpse." Reynolds wanted his own and bought a used Healey that he described as part of an experimental series with four-wheel disc brakes.

Daly had bought a 30-foot boat that he towed behind his Healey to Cannes, joined by Reynolds in his hot rod and a red and black Healey owned by Mickey Ball, a celebrated wheelman who had been with Reynolds on some previous capers.

"With everyone driving sports cars, it was a race every time we got behind the wheel. The women were terrified. They knew that at the end of the night, wherever we were, it was going to be a hairy ride home as the three Healeys raced along the narrow, winding roads, sliding into corners and accelerating away. Fortunately, I had better braking, but not the power of the others," Reynolds recounted.

Reynolds was nearly killed in the Healey, surprisingly while not street racing through France, but by being struck by a lorry that almost sheared the car in half on the road near Arles. While in hospital, Franny told Reynolds she was pregnant. They married on September 7, 1961, and Franny gave birth to their son, Nick.

Never one to let modesty get in his way, Reynolds described his goal as a criminal was to find an El Dorado city-of-gold score while painting his Sistine Chapel ceiling of a crime. He got his opportunity in 1963 when he got a tip from an insider known only as the "Ulsterman" of the bounty to be had on the overnight mail train running between Glasgow and London. Reynolds



The perfect Healey for a professional criminal? Yes, a well-optioned black tri-carb!



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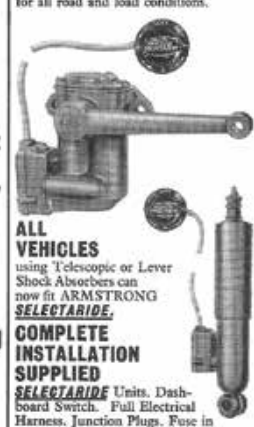
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and his gang stopped the train by altering the trackside signals, breaking into the mail coach, and offloading the loot into some waiting lorries. They proceeded to a previously arranged hideout at Leatherslade Farm at Oakley in Buckinghamshire to let things cool off for a bit. And here is where Reynolds's penchant for Healeys came to the fore once again.

Consider this. You've just committed the crime of the century and the very next day you travel to London to buy a Healey. Things get a bit fuzzy here as some accounts say Reynolds hitchhiked from Leatherslade, but my guess is he was driven to Chequered Flag Motors in Chiswick, London by a woman named Mary Manson, who was suspected of being part of the gang. Reynolds was shown a black Healey, decided to buy it, and came back later that evening with Manson completing the sale in her name for £835 which she paid for in nine bundles of £100, made up of £5 notes stolen in the robbery.

It wasn't just any Healey, either. Delivered new on February 20, 1962, the right-hand drive, disc-wheeled BT7 (HBT718135) had an impressive list of options including a factory hardtop, Philips radio, and overdrive. At some point it acquired a Ruddspeed triple-carb conversion, boosting horsepower from 130 to 180 HP and a pair of Armstrong Selectaride dampers that could be electrically adjusted from the cockpit with a dashboard-mounted switch.



Jimmy White's BJ7 Healey, REN 22, seen here in a newsreel following its sale at auction in 1966.

Publicity for the 1981 sale of Reynolds's BT7 Healey.

On the same day, train robber Jimmy White, using the name John Steward, purchased a BJ7 registered as REN 22 from London Healey dealers Allery & Bernard, Ltd. for £900. And like Reynolds's purchase, it was made in cash consisting of £5 notes.

White and Reynolds used their Healeys to escape from Leatherslade. White didn't get much enjoyment from his new convertible though. The police discovered the Leatherslade hideout on August 13th and on the next day White left the Healey for repair at London garage Zenith Motors and never came back to collect it. He went on the run for three years before being arrested in Kent and Scotland Yard seized the Healey. REN 22 was sold at auction in 1966 along with other items seized from White, including his launch *Karelia* and a caravan that had been abandoned with £30,000 secreted behind

its panel walls. White was sentenced to 18 years in jail. There's no record of what happened to the BJ7 after the auction and the car is not currently registered in the UK Driver and Vehicle Licensing Agency (DVLA) database.

Meanwhile, Reynolds hid out in London with Franny. An article in *The Australian Women's Weekly* in 1969 described their equally short time with their Healey: "Nine days after the robbery, when they were staying with friends, the next blow fell. The Reynolds(es), who hungrily watched each TV news session, saw on the screen a car identical to the one Bruce had bought with 835 Pounds of stolen fivers. On it were their own registration marks. They now knew for certain the police were hunting Bruce for his part in the Great Train Robbery."

Franny was quoted in the article, saying, "I'll never forget the moment when we saw the car flashed on the screen. Bruce jumped up, told me to scrub the flat down, and said he'd be back in about an hour. He took the car – the Austin-Healey the police were looking for, that millions of people had just seen – and drove off. Bruce dumped the car at a garage near London Airport, saying casually to the attendant, 'I'm going abroad'."

This began five years as fugitives for the Reynoldses taking them to Mexico, Canada, and France before returning to

England where Bruce was captured in Torquay in November 1968. He was sentenced to 25 years following his conviction.

222 NFC was sold at auction on February 4, 1969, for £930. The buyer took the car on tour until selling it at auction in 1981. That buyer used it regularly until offering it at auction at H&H auctioneers in Buxton, Derbyshire on October 6, 2004, when it sold for £27,000 to a Swiss museum where it is believed to still reside.

All but one of the train robbers have now passed into the annals of criminal history. Despite the audaciousness and notoriety of their crime, to be clear, they were bad guys. And certainly, Reynolds's purchase of a flash Healey the day after the robbery belies his reputation as a "mastermind." It reminds me of the scene in the movie *Goodfellas* where Robert DeNiro as Lufthansa heist leader Jimmy Conway has one of his underlings show up to a Christmas party with a brand-new pink Cadillac after being admonished not to buy anything big following the robbery. "Johnny, are you nuts? We got a million f'n bulls out there. Everybody's watching us and you get a f'n car!"

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The Reynolds Healey at auction in 1981, the second of three auction sales of the infamous car.